PLAYER 2 LEVEL UP · POLICY

AGE-APPROPRIATE GAMES POLICY

POLICY OWNER	Rory Horseman, Owner, Player 2 Level Up
SAFEGUARDING LEAD	Rory Horseman
DATE ADOPTED	11 November 2026
NEXT REVIEW	11 November 2027

1. OUR APPROACH

At Player 2 Level Up, we recognise that gaming can support young people's confidence, social interaction, communication and wellbeing. We aim to provide a positive, supportive environment while considering the suitability of games for each individual.

We use PEGI age ratings as a guide when selecting games, alongside the young person's age, needs and circumstances.

2. AGE RATINGS AND PARENTAL CHOICE

We recognise that parents and carers are best placed to understand their child's needs and make decisions about the games they play.

We will not routinely select games that are age-inappropriate for a young person. However, where a young person and their parent or carer specifically request a game with an age rating above the young person's age, we may agree to play it during a session.

A game will not automatically be prohibited solely because its PEGI rating exceeds the young person's age. Each request will be considered individually, taking account of the game's content, online features and any relevant safeguarding concerns.

3. ASSESSING GAME SUITABILITY

When considering a requested game, mentors will take account of:

- The young person's age, individual needs and circumstances.
- The PEGI rating and content descriptors.
- Potentially distressing or inappropriate content.
- Online multiplayer, voice chat and interactions with other players.
- Any concerns raised by the young person, parent or carer.

If the mentor has no safeguarding or suitability concerns, the game may be played. If concerns arise, the mentor may discuss these with the parent or carer, seek advice from the Designated Safeguarding Lead or suggest an alternative.

Parental agreement is important but does not override the mentor's responsibility to safeguard the young person.

4. ONLINE SAFETY

Age ratings do not cover every risk associated with online gaming. Mentors must remain alert to inappropriate communication, bullying, harassment, grooming and exposure to unsuitable content.

All sessions must follow the business's Safeguarding and Child Protection Policy and Online Safety Policy. Any safeguarding concerns must be reported in accordance with these procedures.

5. REVIEW

This policy will be reviewed at least annually, or sooner if changes to the service, relevant guidance or safeguarding concerns make a review necessary.

Approved by Rory Horseman, Owner, Player 2 Level Up, on 11 November 2026. Next review due 11 November 2027.